

culture pushing your borders outwards, they can swallow neighboring cities, bringing them under your flag.

The game is turn-based, which makes it slower and more longwinded than the new run of real time strategy games. While a game such as *Command and Conquer* allows

you to manage a whole bunch of things at the same time, the turn-based element will bog you down with micro-management, especially during the later stages of the game. The gameplay though slow is challenging and compelling, like a game of chess.

The game ships with a

decent and weighty (200 pages) manual with a lot of tips and tactics. The graphics and artwork are top notch too. Firaxis has decided not to go with a multiplayer mode, although it might be added in later; this is a sore spot, in a way, in this day and age. Everything about this game

will endear itself to fans of the turn-based genre.

Developer: Firaxis

Genre: Strategy/Management

Contact: Milestone Interactive

Phone: 022-8381614

Web site:

www.civilizationIII.com

Price: Rs 1,299

Rating: ★★★★★

STEP BY STEP HOME NETWORKING WITH WINDOWS XP

Simplifying Networking

Windows XP makes a genuine attempt to bring networking out of its realm of confusion and onto the desks of home users.

Though the informed user will celebrate the improvements in XP's ability, it's the home users at large who still find the whole thing arcane, rigid and way over their heads.

For those looking for a clear and easy to understand guide, this book is an excellent purchase, only if you're fresh and new to computers. The book rivets down the basics starting with what a network is and does, and leads you through to the practice of simple network security. The book hides the heaviness of its subject with its liberal use of

images and large type, and is phrased in a way that is easy to understand.

This Windows-centric handbook makes a good accessory for the software, giving helping tips and advice to consider.

If you know your way around XP and know a little something about networking, you might want to look the other way. Beginners though, can think of it as a primer designed to edify you in the fundamentals of home networking.

Publisher: Prentice-Hall of India Private Limited

Contact: Computer Book Shop

Phone: 022-2070989/2076556

E-mail: cbsbom@giasbm01.vsnl.net.in

Price: Rs 395

Rating: ★★★



2002. The first section of the book deals with databases, the second with interface creation and the third is about building Web interactive databases.

And if you're the kind to fret over computerese, this book is a no jargon guide and explains everything in simple and easy-to-understand language. Learn all about creating forms and reports in a jiffy. This book is an all user

guide and applies to all levels of readers.

A good companion for those of you looking to embark on a database voyage!

Publisher: Prentice-Hall of India Private Limited

Contact: Computer Book Shop

Phone: 022-2070989/2076556

E-mail: cbsbom@giasbm01.vsnl.net.in

Price: Rs 225

Rating: ★★★

ENHANCED A+ GUIDE TO MAINTAINING YOUR PC

Get to know your PC

Although the title may scare you off, this is a very good book for A+ certification aspirants. It manages to address almost all the objectives that are required for the A+ Core and OS exams. Even if you don't want to do an A+ certification, this book is an excellent

guide for getting to know and resolving your PC's hardware and software problems. All the important steps have been clearly explained in detail with excellent photos and screenshots to ensure that you don't goof up. Distributed over 20 chapters, the book starts right from the basics of computer operations and moves on to

hardware, troubleshooting, software problems, networking and Internet fundamentals, building a PC,

etc. It also comes with a CD that has course preparation software similar to the online examination. Nuts & Bolts 98 is a good utility on the CD that helps you practice what you've learnt on the practical level. A+ certification won't be that much of a problem with this book as a starting point.

Publisher: Thomson Learning

Contact: Computer BookShop

Phone: 022-2070989,

2076356

E-mail: cbsbom@giasbm01.vsnl.net.in

Price: Rs 817.60

Rating: ★★★★★



MICROSOFT ACCESS 2002 PLAIN & SIMPLE

Access as Simple as Possible

Are you looking for a simplistic and explanatory guide to learn Access 2002? Then this is just the book to get hold of. Kick start your learning exercise with concise and lucid explanations on how to create databases using Access

